SpeechGeek



Season Eleven: Winter 2014

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As 2013 marches boldly and coldly toward its final days, the online monolith that is Amazon is experimenting with its drone delivery service. Though (at the time of this publication) customers won't anticipate their bulk orders of lip balm to be delivered by autonomous robots until at least 2015, folks are increasingly curious about the most efficient way to obtain their purchases. While we certainly respect the innovation and sheer "woah"-ness of the delivery drones, your friendly neighborhood **SpeechGeek** plans to stick with our current strategy of providing prompt digital downloads for online purchases. As recognized digital publishers by the National Forensic League, your electronic copy of **SpeechGeek** scripts is all you need to get competing. Don't forget your suit, though. That's pretty important, too.

If you're in need of printed scripts, stopwatches, or buttons – we still have you covered! While we can't promise delivery via an automated drone just yet (maybe by the time we're publishing Season Thirty), we do promise to package and ship your items at quickly as our human hands can do it. Welcome to a new year and five new interp scripts!

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

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Pigskin

by Richard Shelton

SCENE ONE

MARK. Every family has rituals. Some involve particular foods, places, or behaviors. Our ritual centers on the pigskin.

DAD. Get 'yer jersey on, son. The game is about to begin.

MARK. My earliest memories practically have buffalo sauce stains. My father and I would sit next to each other on the couch, surrounded by the weekly smorgasbord of junky food my otherwise healthy mother would lovingly prepare.

DAD. (*shouting at television*) Come on, Murphries, you better deliver a victory this time.

MARK. Outside of football, my dad and I couldn't be more different. I guess you could say I was a bit softer than my dad. I preferred to read and listen to music while he…

DAD. (*screaming*) Murphries? What? Was there a bone in the Gatorade? BECAUSE YOU'RE CHOKING!

MARK. …was tougher than me. Very tough.

DAD. You've gotta be kidding me! Can't you take a hit?

MARK. As I got older, high school football seemed like the obvious path way to a little bit of father-son bonding. Unfortunately, the only one I ended up bonding with was J.T.

J.T. (*taunting MARK)* Come on, Mark. You'd better deliver a victory this time.

MARK. I don't know what made him tic.

J.T. What? Was there a bone in your Gatorade? Because you're choking.

MARK. But I knew one thing.

J.T. (*shoves)* Can't you take a hit?

MARK. He wouldn't be content until I was sacked.

SCENE TWO

(*MARK and J.T. are in uniform during a practice. The scene freezes when MARK addresses the audience.*)

J.T. (*grunts and stretches*) Hunh! Ungh! Ahhh… I tell you something, nothing gets me going like crushing bodies on a Saturday morning, eh?

MARK. (*to himself, rolling his eyes and adjusting his mouth guard)* Yeah, right.

J.T. What?

MARK. Huh?

J.T. What did you say?

MARK. Oh, nothing.

J.T. (*moves a bit closer to him*) So, you're telling me you didn't just mumble something under your breath?

Cat and Mouse

by Julia Neva

CAT. (*As the scene opens, CAT stands and focuses on filing nails, ignoring the audience. After a few moments, CAT looks up and speaks with a snarl and an eye roll.)* Ugh. Humans. (*CAT looks down and continues to file nails while appreciating their sharp ness.)* Humans. You're always walking around with your pink, fleshy, hairless air of superiority. (*mocking tone*) "Blah blah blah. Look at me, walking around on my two legs, wearing shoes to pwo-tect my pwe-cious widdle feetsies. Oh – and would you get a load of these thumbs! I'm so evolved!" (*scoffs*) You're disgusting—that's what you are. I spend hours searching for the perfect gift for my person. I lay it down ever so gently on her pillow while she's sleeping so she can wake up thinking, "A present! How wonderful!" Instead, all I hear is, "Auughhh! A dead bird! Ew! Gross! Why did you do this?" And I'm thinking, "Hello… I keep its skull in tact and I don't get so much as a 'thank you?' I'll keep waiting on the handwritten note, I guess." And to think *we're* the ones that have to get spayed and neutered. Ingrates! That's what you all are – ingrates.

(*admiring claws with audience*) Phenomenal, aren't they? These bad boys could slice the skin of a 300-pound lumberjack faster than you could say "me-ouch." As we like to say, a cat is measured by the point of its claws and the wit of its whiskers. Brawns and brains as you humans call them. These have served me well. (*pause*) But they have always fallen just short of where I needed them to land.

I've spent eight lifetimes chasing that mouse. Scrambling, scheming, and stretching to catch that conniving, repulsive rodent for years only to come short of snuffing out his disease-carrying life. Time after time after dreaded time, always just beyond my grasp. (*stares at audience*) But you wouldn't know what that's like, would you?

INTRODUCTION

CAT. It's a misconception that cats are lazy. We prefer to consider it poisonous slander, but since it appears that the human to feline ratio is currently twenty-five to one, I'll stick with the more polite "misconception." Humans look at a cat lying in the sun for three hours and think we're just sleeping our nine lives away. Did it ever occur to you that maybe, just maybe, cats are solar powered? We still need food and water – but we need the warmth of the sun to

catalyze that into energy. The energy we use to hunt down and destroy enemy targets like songbirds, squirrels, mice, insects, fluffy baby bunnies, and first dates.

I don't want to brag, but I'm actually really good at catching things. Like, *scary* good. The birds in the area have a nickname for me that roughly translates into "Shredder of Wings, Destroyer of Hope." (*wistful*) One would think that being able to take down flying objects would make catching a mouse easy.

(*defensive)* Maybe if we were talking about a regular mouse, then yes, it would be easy. But I'm telling you, this one came straight from the sulphuric bowels of the underworld. The first time I found it after hearing my person shriek, I looked into its beady little eyes and I can say with the confidence that the beast was soulless. I'm not exaggerating when I say the thing was sent here to torment me.

It had found a way to burrow a hole in the wall. Night after night, it would just stroll throughout the house in search of food. I'd find it lazily munching on grapes in the fruit bowl or crawling through the holes in a chunk of Swiss cheese. No sooner would I wrap my paws around the filthy little bugger before something bizarre and incredibly convenient would happen to aid in his escape.

Initially I found it humorous, almost interesting. The mouse would sneak out. I would find the mouse. There would be some chasing, some reaching into holes in walls, and "ha-ha!" it got away. It was a literal cat and mouse game. Over time, though, it started to eat away at me. I kept thinking, "What's wrong with you? Get it to gether. It's just a mouse."

Entire days were spent figuring out how to catch the mouse. I've chewed holes into my fur. See? (*shows audience*) You can see patches of skin. My appetite waned. The muscles in my neck, shoulders, and haunches ached from the constant vigilance. Any desire to explore or taunt the birds disappeared. My person would call my name, urging me to come over for a belly rub, but as long I could sense that rodent roaming through the house, I couldn't be distracted.

I've lost sleep. I've lost weight. When I close my eyes, all I see is this…*thing*…this thing that I can't catch. I find myself wanting to drag my claws down the sides of walls just to feel them be useful again. I'm well aware of the fact that while I'm chasing the mouse there's an obsession I cannot escape. Most days, I don't know why it haunts me so.

Once, I started clawing at the hole in the wall where the mouse was. My person, so utterly exhausted with my maniacal behavior swung a broom at my head, screamed for me to stop tearing apart the house. I'm sure the intention was to scare me away, but the sheer force knocked me sideways and I blacked out for a moment.

It all flashes in front of me: my mother, my siblings, the man, (*pause*) the bag. We're in a pile of warmth, milk sitting like dew on our whiskers. We're lifted into a bag and jostled around in vibrating darkness. Before we can even find solid footing – there's weight lessness – then a splash.

I'm too little to know what drowning means but I know I have to get out.

We're all fighting to get out. (*begins a hyperventilating panic while reliving the memory)*

I use my weight to push down on my brothers and sisters, as the water begins to seep into the bag. My claws – strong and sharp – tear at the opening at the top of the bag. Every part of me is flailing to find the light – to feel the warmth of the sun. I don't realize that I can no longer hear the wails of my siblings. When I drag myself to land, I realize that I can no longer see my siblings either. I'm too little to know what dead is, to know they've lost all nine of their lives before they've had a chance to understand one.

But I know they're gone. I'm alone. A human did this to us.

I shake off the wooziness and…(*shock)* it's gone. (*feels around the space in disbelief)* The hole is gone. Not covered up, but like it hadn't been there at all.

(*stunned realization)* I couldn't…I didn't just make it up. (*suddenly defensive, justifying to the audience)* I'm telling you, I didn't make it up. There was a mouse! A nasty, conniving, evil little beast that taunted me at every opportunity possible. That mouse is real! And when I catch him, I'll show you. I'll show all of you humans. There's a reason why I was the toughest. There's a reason why I alone survived, a reason for me to live. My sisters and brothers didn't die in vain.

It's the survival instinct. The mouse has one. I do as well. But what he doesn't know is just how far I will go to preserve it.

Now, if you'll excuse me, I'm exhausted and in need of some rest.